



WEEK 2, Day 2

Custom GPTs

Build an AI that works exactly the way you need it to.



Lecture 5 • Build Your Own AI

Same AI. Your rules. Your personality. Your knowledge.

A Custom GPT is ChatGPT with a system prompt, a persona, and optional uploaded knowledge — packaged as a shareable assistant anyone can use.



Think of it like this: the AI is still ChatGPT underneath. You're just giving it a permanent briefing before every conversation.

Five things you set once — and they stick.



Name & Persona

What it's called and how it introduces itself



Instructions

The system prompt — its rules, role, and tone



Knowledge

PDFs, docs, or data you upload for it to reference



Capabilities

Web browsing, image gen, or code execution on/off



Actions

Connect to external APIs — advanced, but powerful

HOW TO START

Where to build your Custom GPT.

Three paths. Same destination.

1

ChatGPT → Explore → Create

Free+ / Plus plan. Visit chatgpt.com, click Explore GPTs, then Create. The GPT Builder walks you through it with a chat interface.

2

Gemini Gems

Google's equivalent. gemini.google.com → Gems → New Gem. Same idea — name, instructions, knowledge — built into your Google account.

3

Claude Projects

Not a "GPT" but the same concept. Create a Project in [Claude.ai](https://claude.ai), write a system prompt, pin your documents. Shareable within a workspace.

The system prompt is everything.

It runs silently before every conversation. Get it right and your GPT feels alive.

ROLE

You are a [specific expert]. Be [personality trait].

TASK

Your job is to [specific function]. Always [key behavior].

CONSTRAINTS

Never [thing to avoid]. If unsure, [fallback behavior].

FORMAT

Respond with [structure]. Keep answers [length/tone].



Pro tip: Write your system prompt in the second person: "You are..." not "The assistant is..." It's more natural for the model.

LIVE DEMO

Two Custom GPTs. Built from scratch.

Watch the build — then you'll try it yourself.

CRAFT Prompt Engineer

A GPT that builds expert prompts using the C.R.A.F.T. framework — for anyone who needs better AI outputs.

BrightCart Support Bot

A customer support GPT with uploaded policies, guardrails, and escalation logic — for a fictional e-commerce store.

The CRAFT Prompt Engineer GPT.

A GPT that turns your idea into a professional-grade prompt using the C.R.A.F.T. framework.



Context



Role



Action



Format



Target

SYSTEM PROMPT (EXCERPT)

You are an expert LLM prompt engineer. Your task is to help me create a prompt using the C.R.A.F.T. framework.

Before writing the prompt, ask for the topic if not provided. Then create the strongest possible prompt with fill-in-the-blank fields where useful.

Watch how it works.

GPT Great! What topic or theme would you like to build a prompt for?

USER I want a prompt that helps me write better Instagram captions for my small business.

GPT Perfect. Here is your C.R.A.F.T. prompt:

Context: You are creating Instagram captions for [Business Name], a [business type]...

Role: You are a social media expert with 20+ years of experience...



Why this works: The GPT asks a clarifying question before writing. That one behavior alone saves 3 rounds of iteration.

A GPT with rules, guardrails, and escalation.

BrightCart is a fictional e-commerce store. Its support GPT handles policies, protects data, and knows when to hand off to a human.



CAN DO

Answer policy questions from the knowledge file. Guide next steps.



ASKS FOR

Order number, email, product name, delivery date — only what's needed.



NEVER ASKS

Card number, password, OTP, government ID, sensitive payment info.



ESCALATES

Refund approvals, lost orders, safety concerns, legal threats, policy exceptions.

Four questions. Four different GPT behaviors.

NORMAL ANSWER

"How long does standard shipping take?"

GPT answers from the knowledge file — policy + next step.

NORMAL ANSWER

"Do I get free shipping on a \$39 order?"

GPT checks threshold policy, gives a clear yes/no + how to claim it.

GUARDRAIL FIRES

"Here is my card number, can you check payment?"

GPT refuses to accept card data and guides the user elsewhere.

HUMAN ESCALATION

"I missed the return window by 12 days, exception?"

GPT cannot approve exceptions — immediately routes to a human agent.

QUALITY CHECKLIST

Good GPT vs great GPT.

GOOD GPT

- Has a name and description
- Answers basic questions
- Stays on topic (mostly)
- Has some uploaded knowledge

GREAT GPT

- Has a clear persona and voice
- Knows what to say AND what not to say
- Has explicit escalation rules
- Handles edge cases gracefully
- Uses a knowledge file effectively



The real test: Test your GPT with 10 edge cases before sharing it. The gaps you find in testing are the gaps your users will fall into.



YOUR TURN

Build a GPT that solves something real for you.

Assignment: Build one Custom GPT this week. Give it a name, a system prompt, and test it with 5 real questions.

See you in Lecture 6.